
HELP-WANTED PAGES ARE PURCHASE ORDERS

How to Read Job Postings as Buying Signals — and Call the Decisionmaker Months Before the Trades Report Anything

A Special Report from **Hollywood Sales Wire** — the intelligence brief for people who sell into entertainment.

This report comes in two parts, and completes a prospecting system. The Spend Map tells you who has money. The Greenlight Window tells you which projects just got funded. Part One of this report reveals the tell — reading requisitions as buying signals. Part Two hands you the starter kit: the watchlist, the dictionary, and the weekly routine, ready to run this week.

The one-minute version

- **A job posting is money in motion.** A press release is a positioning
- statement of what's happened; a requisition reveals what it's actually funding, because every hire carries a cost the

company has already budgeted. No company hires a director of live events and then decides whether to do live events.

- **In production, the first hires ARE the buyers.** The unit production manager (UPM) — the final approver on below-the-line spending — and the production accountant, who builds the purchase-order system, are among the first people hired when a project enters prep [1][2]. A UPM posting is not HR news; it is the arrival of the person who will sign your purchase order.
- **The lag is your head start.** Prep runs 4 to 12 weeks on an indie, 8 to 16 on a studio feature [3]. The requisition posts at the start of that clock; the trades report at the end of it.
- **This is happening in the open right now** — Netflix's live-sports Los Angeles requisition posted in April and filled in July [4]; Amazon carrying 400+ open sports-production roles as the streamers build live capability [5]; Lionsgate's new 450,000-square-foot Atlanta complex staffing up around Georgia's uncapped credit [6]. Each is a vendor stack being assembled in public, ahead of any announcement. Section 3 reads all three.
- **And if running all this sounds like a bit much** — that is exactly what the weekly Hollywood Sales Wire is for. The wire reads the requisitions, the award lists, and the permits every week and flags the signals in your category. It is, plainly, your new-leads source. How to use the Special Reports and the weekly wire together is at the end of this report.

Every claim below is printed with its receipt. Where a figure is an industry range or a vendor-published statistic, it is labeled as one.

PART ONE: THE METHOD

1. The honest document

Key line: companies lie in press releases and tell the truth in job postings.

Every requisition carries a loaded cost the company has already approved — which is why hiring pages leak truth that press releases never do. The video-game industry proves it as a running joke: unannounced projects at major studios are routinely outed by job listings, because a studio must describe the role and tools publicly to attract talent, NDA or not [7]. Entertainment journalists mine careers pages for scoops. Salespeople mostly don't — and that gap is this report.

Cross-industry B2B research puts rough numbers on the mechanism: most openings post within about 30 days of budget approval, and hiring signals precede vendor research by 60 to 90 days [8] (sales-vendor figures — direction, not decimals). In production the logic is stronger than any statistic, for a structural reason:

2. First hires are the buyers

Key line: production hiring is project-based — so the posting IS the project announcement, and the earliest titles posted are precisely the people who control the money.

A studio does not carry a unit production manager on staff waiting for work; the UPM is hired when a specific project enters prep. And the staffing sequence is close to canonical [1][2]:

1. **Line producer / UPM** — the financial hub. The production office cannot operate until the UPM is in place; it is the DGA-

recognized top below-the-line position and the final approver on below-the-line spending.

2. **Production accountant** — among the first crew to arrive; sets up payroll and the purchase-order system every vendor flows through.
3. **Production coordinator** — the person who actually places the calls to vendors.
4. **Department heads** — who submit vendor requests upward for the UPM's approval.

You are not inferring that a buyer exists. You are watching the buyer get hired, weeks before the first vendor call goes out.

3. Three signals flashing right now

Key line: the method is live — here are three vendor stacks being assembled in public as this report goes out.

The Netflix proof case. Netflix posted a live-sports production role in Los Angeles in late April 2026 and filled it by early July [4]. (How do we know it filled? The posting vanished — and that is the only notice anyone gets. Below-the-line hires are never announced; the disappearing ad is the announcement, visible only to people watching the page.) Between those dates, a careers-page reader knew — no leak, no rumor — that live-event capability was being assembled in LA: camera, switching, transmission, staging, insurance, crewing. The announcement, whenever it comes, ends the sales window. The requisition opened it.

The live-sports arms race. It is not one company. As of late July 2026, Amazon lists 400+ open sports-related roles as the streamers race to become live broadcasters [5]. Live event production runs on outside vendors — remote trucks, switching,

transmission, staging, crewing — and every one of those hires precedes a vendor stack that mostly does not exist inside these companies yet.

The facility build-out. Lionsgate's Great Point Studios complex in metro Atlanta — 450,000 square feet — is staffing operations as of July 2026, ahead of productions loading in, around Georgia's uncapped 30 percent credit [6]. A facility hires operations staff months before the first production loads in, and every stage it opens pulls in productions that will each hire their own UPM, accountant, and coordinator. One facility posting predicts a whole chain of project postings.

Highest-priority move: pick the five companies whose budgets you most want a piece of and run the 15-minute weekly review in Part Two. That habit alone puts you 60 to 90 days ahead of everyone who waits for the trades.

4. Working the signal: the playbook

Key line: watch the source, map the title, call when it fills — and let the posting write your opening line.

1. **Build your watchlist** from the starter kit in Part Two.
2. **Map the titles to your product line** with the dictionary in Part Two. A payroll service watches for accountants; a lighting house watches for gaffers; a dubbing studio watches for localization coordinators.
3. **Move when the posting fills.** The posting says the money is approved; the fill says the buyer has a name. The weeks after a UPM or coordinator hire are the highest-percentage cold-call window in the industry.
4. **Let the requisition write the pitch.** "I saw you're staffing a production office in Albuquerque — we supply [X] to productions at that stage, here's who we've done it for, here's

a number.” You are not guessing at their situation; they published it.

5. **Stack the signals.** A posting plus an award-list entry (The Greenlight Window) plus a permit filing is close to certainty. One signal is a lead; two is a prospect; three is a call you make today.

PART TWO: THE STARTER KIT

The role-to-purchase dictionary

Find your row: every job title maps to the vendor category it is about to buy from.

When they post for...	They are about to buy...
UPM / line producer	Everything below the line — the master signal
Production accountant	Payroll services, accounting software, banking
Production coordinator	Office space, supplies, travel, shipping, radios
Location manager	Locations, permits, security, fencing, sanitation
Transportation coordinator	Vehicles, fuel, drivers, logistics
Construction coordinator	Lumber, materials, stage space, tool rental
Gaffer / key grip	Lighting and grip packages, power, expendables
Post supervisor	Editorial systems, color, sound, delivery services
VFX producer / coordinator	VFX vendors, render capacity, data management
Dubbing / localization roles	Dubbing studios, subtitling, voice talent
Live-event / broadcast roles	Remote trucks, switching, transmission, staging
Studio operations (new facility)	

When they post for...	They are about to buy...
	Everything above, repeatedly — a facility posting predicts a chain of project postings

Two rows deserve a note. Localization rides a global dubbing and subtitling market measured in the billions and growing on streaming scale [9] — when a platform posts dubbing coordinators for a territory, a content wave for that territory is already funded. And live events is the newest column, per Section 3: the capability is being built now, and the vendor rosters with it.

The watchlist

Where the requisitions live. Pick your five and bookmark them.

- **Streamer and studio careers pages** — every major maintains one (Netflix, Amazon MGM, Disney, Warner Bros. Discovery, NBCU, Sony, Paramount, Apple, Lionsgate). Filter to production, post, operations, and live-event roles in your territory. These carry the staff and capability hires — the Section 3 class of signal.
- **Crew staffing platforms** — where productions post project hires. The largest carries 350,000 production profiles and thousands of hiring companies, with postings free to employers [10] — meaning even small indies post there. This is where the UPM/accountant/coordinator class of signal appears.
- **Production listings services** — the industry directories that track projects in prep and crewing up, useful for confirming that a posting cluster equals a real project.
- **State film office pipelines** — Georgia's production list, New Mexico's registrations: cross-reference a hiring cluster against these and you have a stacked signal.

The 15-minute weekly routine

1. Open your five careers pages and one staffing platform. Filter to new postings this week, your territory, production/post/ops titles.
 2. Run each hit against the dictionary: is this title a buyer for what you sell?
 3. Check for fills: did last week's UPM or coordinator posting disappear? A vanished posting usually means filled — the buyer now has a name; find the production office. (Occasionally it means pulled or reposted, which is why you stack signals before calling.)
 4. Stack: does the company or project also appear on an award list or in a state pipeline? Stacked signals move to the top of the call sheet.
 5. Log what you saw. Three weeks of logs will show you the rhythm of your territory better than any directory.
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If this sounds like a bit much — read this

Here is the honest truth about this method: it works, and it takes discipline. Five careers pages, one staffing platform, the award lists from The Greenlight Window, the state pipelines — every week, without missing one, because the weeks you skip are the weeks the signals fire.

That is exactly what the weekly **Hollywood Sales Wire** is for. The wire runs this entire routine at scale — every studio, every streamer, every staffing platform, every state program — and lands in your inbox with the signals already read, matched, and flagged by category. It is, plainly, **your new-leads source**: not a newsletter you read for interest, but a hot lead feed you can work for revenue.

How to use the Special Reports and the weekly wire together:

1. **The Special Reports build your machine.** The Spend Map gives you the territory (who has money and which doors it moves through). The Greenlight Window gives you the prospect list (funded projects by name). This report gives you the timing (which of them is buying this week). Read once, set up once.
2. **The weekly wire keeps the machine loaded.** New award rounds, fresh requisition clusters, permit activity — each issue updates your prospecting list with new leads while they are days old, not months.
3. **You make the calls the crowd hasn't thought of yet.** The sequence each week is short: open the wire, mark the signals in your category, cross them against your territory, and contact the decisionmaker — the UPM, the line producer, the production office — while the budget is still open and before the trades tell your competitors it exists.

Run that loop and you own a real competitive advantage that compounds: your prospect list is always current, your calls are always early, and the vendor who is always early becomes the vendor already in place when everyone else finally rings.

What to do this week

Pick your five companies, bookmark the pages, run the routine once. One filled production-office requisition in your territory, called within the week, is worth more than a hundred stale directory contacts. And if you'd rather have all of it read for you, the wire arrives weekly.

Method and limits

The staffing-sequence and financial-authority descriptions reflect standard US production practice (DGA-recognized UPM authority, conventional production-office structure); individual productions vary, and staff roles at streamers differ from project-based crew hires. The B2B hiring-signal statistics in Section 1 are published by sales-intelligence vendors, not peer-reviewed research — cited for direction, not precision. Prep-length ranges are industry-standard figures and vary by project. Open-role counts (Amazon, Netflix) are snapshots from public job boards at the time of writing and change daily. A job posting signals funded activity; it does not guarantee any specific production, budget size, or timeline. Read requisitions as probability, stack signals for confidence, and let the first call qualify the rest.

About Hollywood Sales Wire

Hollywood Sales Wire is the intelligence brief for people who sell into entertainment. Every issue reads the public record the way a salesperson needs it read: award lists as prospect lists, job requisitions as buying signals, permits as early warnings. The Special Reports show the method; the wire runs it every week — so the signal reaches you while the budget is still open.

Hollywood Sales Wire publishes every week. The Special Reports show the method; the wire runs it for you — new award lists, requisitions, and permits read as buying signals and delivered while the window is still open.

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